

compliant colour management system exposed through Win32 API functions, so it is readily available to any application, device driver, device calibration tool, or Color Management Module (CMM). Windows itself, and many Windows-based software applications, use ICM 2.0 'under the covers' to improve the appearance of pictures and graphics.

Until now, Windows has lacked a central Control Panel interface for managing ICC colour profiles and ICM 2.0 colour settings across the system. The new Microsoft Color Control Panel Applet for Windows XP addresses this by adding a Color tool to the Control Panel, making it easier for you to manage Windows colour settings.

SyncToy

These days, files come from every direction: digital cameras, e-mail, cell phones, portable media players, camcorders, and PDAs. Increasingly, computer users are using different folders, drives, and even different computers (such as a laptop and a desktop) to store and retrieve files. Managing hundreds or thousands of files is still largely a manual operation. In some cases it is necessary to get copies of files from one place; in other cases there is a need to keep two storage locations exactly in sync.

SyncToy is a free PowerToy that provides an easy-to-use, highly customisable program that helps users to do the heavy lifting involved with the copying, moving, and synchronisation of different folders. Most common operations can be performed with just a few clicks of the mouse, and additional customisation is available without added complexity.

SyncToy can manage multiple sets of folders at the same time; it can combine files from two folders in one case, and mimic renames and deletes in another.

RAW Image Thumbnailer and Viewer

If you're a serious photographer, you can now organise and work with digital RAW files in Windows Explorer, much as you can with JPEG images. This tool provides thumbnails, previews, printing, and metadata display for RAW images.

[Alt] + [Tab] Replacement

If you constantly run several applications, the [Alt] + [Tab] application switching functionality in Windows would be one of your most often used key presses. This PowerToy replaces that functionality using a thumbnail preview of each window in the task list, displayed in a manner consistent with XP's look and feel.

Here's how it works. Once you have two or more applications running, hold down [Alt] and press [Tab]. This displays the first application window in the task list, using an attractive thumbnail image. Release [Alt] and [Tab] to select that application, or hit [Tab] repeatedly until you find the application to which you'd like to switch.

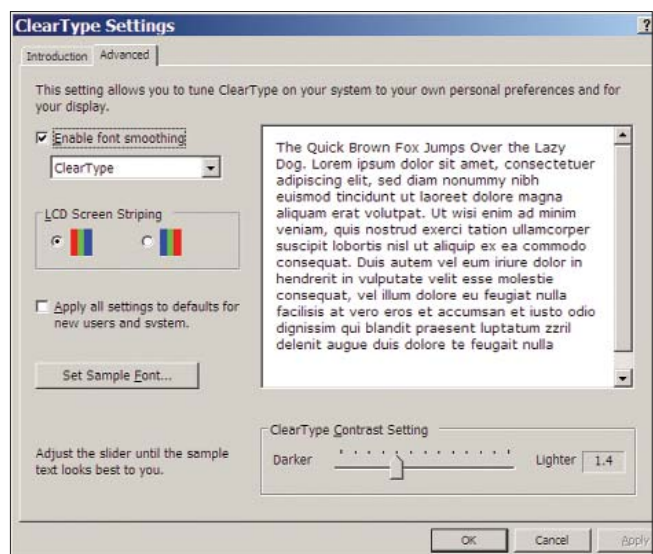
This PowerToy could be a pain to use. The problem is speed—generating and displaying the thumbnails could bog down the system.

CD Slide Show Generator

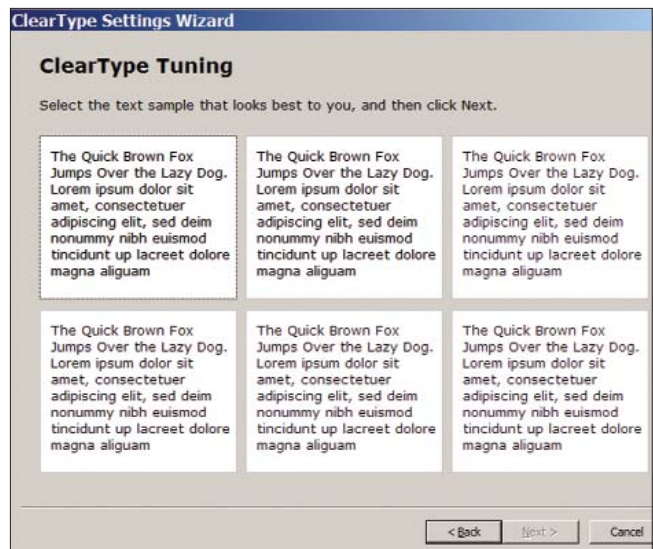
This tool is great if you're into digital photography. It generates a slideshow of digital photos or other images. The CD Slide Show Generator integrates into XP's CD Recording Wizard, providing an extra step when you're trying to burn image-only CDs. There's even an option that asks whether you'd like to add a picture viewer to the CD; if you choose 'Yes', you can bring the CD to a non-XP PC and still view the slideshow!

ClearType Tuner

One of the biggest usability improvements in Windows XP was the inclusion of ClearType



XP has always lacked a way to fine-tune ClearType, which is a necessary feature, since different displays and different people's eyes prefer different types of text display. Now, ClearType Tuner gives you the freedom to do this successfully



technology, which effectively triples the horizontal resolution of text displayed on your LCD display. However, XP has always lacked a way to fine-tune ClearType, which is a necessary feature, since different displays and different people's eyes prefer different types of text display. With the addition of the ClearType Tuner, XP users can get OS-level ClearType tuning capabilities.

ClearType Tuner installs as a Control Panel applet called ClearType Tuning (the applet itself is called ClearType Settings). You can run it in two modes—either as a wizard that steps you through the process, or in an

Advanced mode where you modify sample text until you get the effect you desire.

This PowerToy is even more recommended if you're using ClearType on an LCD display.

Slide Show Wizard

The Slide Show Wizard—previously called the HTML Slide Show Wizard—is a standalone application that generates a Web-based slideshow. You can add individual pictures and folders—though the 'Browse for Folder' dialog it uses begins in 'My Documents' rather than 'My Pictures'.

In the next step, you can name the slideshow, provide